

Name: _____

Day 1: Brainstorming (50 minutes)

This week you will be writing a personal narrative, similar to Grace's story. Today you will brainstorm, then tomorrow you will begin writing. It is due Tuesday.

STEP 1: Brainstorming

1. Narrative Idea: Jot down story Ideas that fall into each category:

A. A moment when you felt misunderstood or judged by others, similar to how Grace struggles with perception.	B. A time when memory or truth was complicated—when remembering something felt confusing or unreliable.	C. An experience of facing difficult decisions or feeling trapped by circumstances.
D. A moment when you (or a fictional character) felt misunderstood or judged by others.	E. A time when memory or truth was confusing or unreliable.	F. An experience of facing difficult decisions or feeling trapped by circumstances.

2. Now, choose one! Which do you choose? A B C D E F

3. Main Event or Conflict

What is your story about? Describe the main event or challenge.

4. Setting

Where and when does your story take place?

5. Characters

Who is involved in your narrative? (Yourself or others)

6. Point of View and Tone

Write your narrative's point of view is first person. What is the tone you want (serious, reflective, hopeful, etc.)?

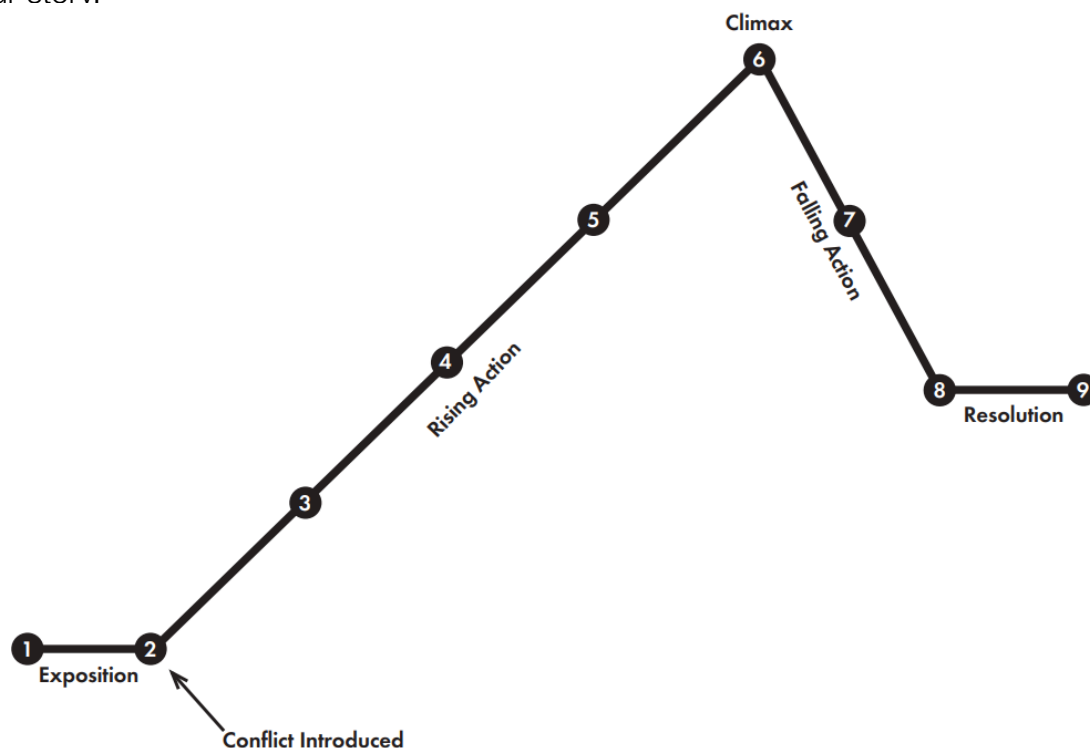
7. View this presentation to learn how to write a story.

<https://prezi.com/view/ePCEvpZDKJ3RhLLj4ZN7/>

8. Read one of the sample papers here: [4StudentSamples.pdf](#)

Complete the table on the next page based on the sample story you chose.

9. Now use the diagram to complete the second table based on what you plan to write for your story.



FOR #8: FILL OUT THE TABLE USING THE SAMPLE STORY YOU CHOSE

STORY STEPS	WHAT SAMPLE STORY WROTE FOR EACH STEP
Exposition 1	
Conflict Introduced 2	
3	
Rising Action 4	
5	
Climax 6	
Falling Action 7	
8	

9	
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FOR #9: FILL OUT THIS TABLE BASED ON WHAT YOU PLAN TO WRITE FOR YOUR OWN STORY.

STORY STEPS	WHAT YOU PLAN TO WRITE
Exposition 1	
Conflict Introduced 2	
3	
Rising Action 4	
5	
Climax 6	
Falling Action 7	
8	

9	
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Day 2: Writing Your First Draft (50 minutes)

Task:

- Start a new Google Doc for your first draft.
- Write the first draft of your personal narrative (3 to 4 paragraphs). There is no exact length requirement, but you should expect 2-3 pages double-spaced when complete.
- Focus on:
 - Setting the scene with clear descriptions
 - Showing your thoughts and feelings about the experience
 - Using dialogue or inner reflection where appropriate
 - Creating a strong sense of mood or emotion
- Write in the first person (using “I”).
- Use vivid details to engage the reader.
- **Share the draft with me!**

Day 3: Revising and Finalizing Your Narrative (50 minutes)

Task:

- Revise your draft:
- Ensure your narrative has all nine **story steps** from the diagram
- Add or improve descriptive details and reflections
- Check for smooth transitions and logical flow
- Correct grammar, punctuation, and spelling errors

Personal Narrative Essay Rubric

Criteria	30 – Excellent	20 – Satisfactory	10 – Needs Improvement
Narrative Structure	All nine story parts present	Has minor lapses	Unclear or incomplete structure
Detail & Description	Vivid, engaging details and reflection	Adequate description	Minimal detail or unclear
Language & Voice	Consistent, expressive voice	Some voice and expression	Flat or inconsistent voice
Mechanics	Few to no grammar/spelling errors	Some errors but not distracting	Frequent errors hinder clarity
Completion	Completed by 10/21/25	Late but submitted	Not submitted or incomplete

